

Which WATCH?

Choosing a watch is not easy. No longer just timepieces, watches today pack functions that you may have never considered before. Here we help you choose one that suits your lifestyle

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In this age of cellphones, most people never wear a watch. Why should I wear a watch just to know the time when I carry a cellphone almost always?—you may ask. Even the most basic of the cellphones today is a multipurpose device capable of voice calls, SMS, FM radio, MP3 player, voice recorder, alarm, etc besides showing the current time.

But to say that watches have lost ground to cellphones would rather be unfair. A watch is often more about fashion than function. It's a reflection of you and your lifestyle, just like the clothes you wear or the car you drive in.

This is the reason why luxury watches like Rolex continue to be popular.

In response to multifunction phones, some watchmakers have already begun to add functions like heart rate monitors and GPS trackers to their timepieces. And there are even watches with cellphones built in now.

There is a whole

range of watches available in the market, which can broadly be categorised into:

1. **Digital.** Casio is a renowned digital watchmaker. Digital watches can offer multiple features, especially for sports and navigation. These come with an LCD screen. Price starts from a few hundred rupees and goes up to Rs 20,000-30,000.

2. **Analogue.** Analogue watches have a traditional look with an hour hand and a minute hand and numbers or numerals around the face. These start from a few hundred rupees and go up to millions.

3. **Digi-analogue.** These watches are a combination of both a digital display and the traditional hands and numbers of an analogue watch. They start from a few hundred rupees.

4. **Chronograph.** Chronograph watches fall under all of the above categories and offer a very precise measure of time down to the millisecond. These start from Rs 4000-5000.

The wide availability of watch styles and features may confuse you. So if you are buying a watch for yourself or someone else, see what is it for. The watch you select should be appropriate for the activities that you intend to use it for. The list below will help you choose a watch that fits your needs, style and taste perfectly.

A watch for everyone

Luxury. If you live a lavish lifestyle, you will want a watch with a classic design and craftsmanship. Here, you can choose between the likes of Rolex, Omega, Movado, Rado, Longines and Tag Heur. These brands may cost anywhere in five to six digits. Rado starts from Rs 16,000 and Longines from Rs 20,000. There are also watches made in gold and studded with diamonds. An expensive branded watch can cost upwards of Rs 200,000.

Fashion. If you are fashion-conscious, a watch with cutting-edge style both in terms of colour and design is one for you. You may want to own

